

CPS Mid-1

Chapter 1

Communication

The process of creating or sharing meaning in informal conversation, group interaction or public speaking.

Participants

Individual who assume the roles of senders and receivers during an interaction.

Messages

Verbal utterances, visual images and non verbal behaviour to which meaning is attributed during an interaction.

Meanings

Thoughts in our minds and interpretation of others messages.

Symbols

Words, sounds and actions that are generally understood to represent ideas and feelings.

Encoding

The process of putting our thoughts and feelings into verbal and nonverbal cues.

Decoding

The process of interpreting anothers messages.

Context

The setting in which communication occurs, including what precedes and follows what is said.

Physical Context

A communication, encounters location, environmental conditions (temperature, lightning, noise levels), distance between communicators, seating arrangements and time of the day.

Social Context

The nature of the relationships that exists between the participants.

Historical Context

The background provided by previous communication episodes between the participants that influence understandings in the current encounter.

Psychological Context

The mood and feelings each person brings to a conversation.

Cultural Context

The values, attitudes, beliefs, orientations and underlying assumptions prevalent among people in society.

Channel

Both the route travelled by message and the means of transportation.

Interference

Any stimulus that interferes with the process of sharing meaning.

Physical Interference

Sights, sounds and other stimuli in the environment that draw peoples attention away from intending meaning.

Psychological Interference

Internal distractions based on thoughts, feelings or emotional reactions to symbols.

Internal Noise

Thoughts and feelings that compete for attention and interfere with communication process.

Sematic Noise

Distractions aroused by certain symbols that take our attention away from the main message.

Feedback

Reactions and responses to messages.

Communication Setting

The different communication environment within which people interact, characterized by the number of participants and extent to which the interaction is formal or informal is called communication setting.

Intrapersonal Communication

The interactions that occurs in a persons mind when he or she is talking with himself or herself.

Interpersonal Communication

Informal interaction between two people who have identifiable relationships with each other.

Small Group Communication

Two to 20 participants who come together for the specific purpose of solving a problem or arriving at a decision.

Public Communication

One participant, the speaker, delivers a prepared message to a group or audience who has assembled to hear the speaker.

Spontaneous Expressions

Messages spoken without much conscious thought.

Scripted Messages

Phrasing learned from past encounters that we judge to be appropriate to the present situation.

Constructed Messages

Messages put together with careful thought when we realise that our known scripts are inadequate for the situation.

Immediacy

The degree of liking and attractiveness in a relationship.

Control

The degree to which one participant is perceived to be more dominant or powerful.

Culture

Systems of knowledge shared by relatively large group of people.

Ethics

A set of moral principles that may be held by a society, a group or an individual.

Ethical Dilemma

A choice involving two unsatisfactory alternatives.

Communication Competence

The impression that communicative behaviour is both appropriate and effective in a given situation.

Credibility

A perception of a speaker's knowledge, trustworthiness and warmth.

Social Ease

Communicating without appearing to be anxious or nervous.

Communication Apprehension

Fear or anxiety associated with real or anticipated communication with others.

Chapter 2

Perception

The process of selectively attending information and assigning meaning to it.

Pattern

A set of characteristics used to differentiate some things from others.

Interpret

Assigning meaning to information.

Self-Concept

Your self identity. The mental image you have about your skills, your ability, your knowledge, your competences and your personality.

Self-Esteem

Your overall evaluation of your competence and personal worthiness.

Ideal Self-Concept

What you would like to be.

Incongruence

The gap between our inaccurate self perception and reality.

Self-Fulfilling Prophecy

A false perception of a situation or characteristic or skill that leads to behaviours that perpetuate that false perception as true.

Self-Talk

The internal conversation we have with ourselves.

Self-Monitoring

The internal process of observing, analyzing and regulating your own behaviour based on your analysis of the situation and others responses to you.

Role

A pattern of learned behaviours that people used to meet the perceived demands of a particular context.

Uncertainty Reduction

The process of monitoring the social environment to learn more about self and others.

Implicit Personality Theories

Assumptions about which physical characteristics and personality traits or behaviours are associated with one another.

Halo Effect

To generalize and perceive that a person has a whole set of characteristics when you have actually observed only one characteristic, trait or behaviour.

Stereotypes

Generalizations, usually exaggerated or oversimplified and often offensive, use to describe or distinguish a group.

Prejudice

A rigid attitude that is based on group membership and predisposes an individual to feel, think or act in a negative way another person or group.

Discrimination

A negative action towards a social group or its members on account of group membership.

Perception Check

A message that reflects your understanding of the meaning of another person's non verbal behaviour.

Chapter 3

Language

A body of symbols and the systems for their use in messages that are common to the people of the same speech community.

Speech Community

A group of people who speak the same language.

Words

Symbols used by a speech community to represent objects, ideas and feelings.

Sapir-Wharf hypothesis

A theory claiming that language influences perception.

Denotation

The direct, explicit meaning a speech community formally gives a word.

Connotation

The feelings or evaluations we associate with a word.

Syntactic Context

The position of a word in a sentence and other words around it.

Low Context Cultures

Cultures in which messages are direct, specific and detailed.

High Context Cultures

Cultures in which messages are indirect, general and ambiguous.

Feminine Styles of Language

Use words of empathy and support, emphasize concrete and personal language, and show politeness and tentativeness in speaking.

Masculine Styles of Languages

Use words of status and problem solving, emphasize abstract and general language, and show assertiveness and control in speaking.

Specific Words

Words that clarify meaning by narrowing what is understood from general category to a particular item or group within that category.

Concrete Words

Words that appeal to senses and help us see, hear, smell, taste or touch.

Precise Words

Words that narrows a larger category to a smaller group within that category.

Dating Information

Specifying the time or time period that a fact was true or known to be true.

Indexing Generalizations

The mental and verbal practice of acknowledging the presence of individual differences when voicing generalizations.

Vivid Wording

Wording that is full of life, vigorous, bright and intense.

Simile

A direct comparison of dissimilar things.

Metaphor

A comparison that establishes a figurative identity between objects being compared.

Emphasis

The importance given to certain words or ideas.

Jargon

Technical terms whose meanings are understood only by select groups.

Linguistic Sensitivity

Language choices that demonstrate respect for listener.

Slang

Informal vocabulary used by particular groups in society.

Generic Language

Using words that may apply to one sex, race or other group as though they represent everyone.

Chapter 4

Non Verbal Communication Behaviours

Bodily actions and vocal qualities that typically accompany a verbal message.

Emoticons

Typed symbols that convey emotional aspects of an online message.

Kinesics

The interpretation of how body motions communicate.

Gestures

Movements of our hands, arms and fingers that we use to describe or to emphasize.

Illustrators

Gestures that augment a verbal message.

Emblems

Gestures that can substitute for words.

Adaptors

Gestures that respond to a physical need.

Eye Contact or Gaze

How and how much we look at people with whom we are communicating.

Oculesics

How and how much we look at others while communicating.

Facial Expressions

The arrangement of facial muscles to communicate emotional states or reactions to messages.

Posture

The position and movement of body.

Body Orientation

Posture in relation to another person.

Body Movement

Movements that helps clarify meaning or movement that distracts listeners from point being made.

Haptics

What and how touch communicates.

Vocalics

The interpretation of message based on the paralinguistic features.

Paralanguage

The voiced but not verbal part of the language.

Pitch

The highness or lowness of vocal tone.

Volume

The loudness or softness of tone.

Rate

The speed at which person speaks.

Quality

The sound of a persons voice that distinguishes it from others.

Intonation

The variety, melody or inflection in ones voice.

Vocalized Pauses

Extraneous sounds or words that interrupt fluent speech.

Proxemics

The interpretation of a use of space and distance.

Personal Space

The distance you try to maintain when you interact with other people.

Physical Space

The physical environment over which you exert control.

Artifacts

Objects and possessions we use to decorate the physical space we control.

Chronemics

The interpretation of persons use of time.

Monochronic Time Orientation

A time orientation that emphasizes doing only one thing at once.

Polychronic Time Orientation

A time orientation that emphasizes doing multiples things at once.

Endomorph

Round and heavy body type.

Mesomorph

Muscular and athletic body.

Ectomorph

Lean and little muscle development.